

Lab 8 - OpenClaw Dashboard

Access the OpenClaw web dashboard to monitor your agent, view logs, manage plugins, and inspect memory - all from a browser.

Lab environment: Hostinger VPS (from Lab 1) or Docker Desktop (Windows 10/11, macOS 12+, Ubuntu 22.04+)

Prerequisite: Lab 1 completed - gateway running on port 18789. Estimated time: 20 minutes

Option A - Docker Desktop (Local Machine)

Step A1 - Get Your Dashboard Token

The dashboard requires a token for authentication. Retrieve it:

```
docker exec openclaw sh -c 'node -e "const c=require(process.env.HOME+"\ Cant openclaw/openclaw.json"); console.log(c.gateway.auth.token);"'
```

Copy the token printed.

Step A2 - Open the Dashboard

Open your browser and go to:

```
http://localhost:18789/?token=YOUR_TOKEN_HERE
```

Replace YOUR_TOKEN_HERE with the token from Step A1.

Step A3 - Or Launch via CLI

```
docker exec -it openclaw openclaw dashboard
```

This prints the full dashboard URL with token included. Copy and open it in your browser.

Option B - VPS (SSH Tunnel)

The dashboard runs on the VPS but is not exposed publicly. Access it securely via SSH tunnel.

Step B1 - Create an SSH Tunnel (on your local machine)

Open a terminal on your local machine (not on the VPS):

```
ssh -L 18789:localhost:18789 root@YOUR_VPS_IP
```

Keep this terminal open.

Step B2 - Get the Dashboard URL on the VPS

On the VPS: ``bash openclaw dashboard --no-open ``

This prints the URL with token. Open it in your local browser while the SSH tunnel is active.

Step 3 - Explore the Dashboard

View Live Logs

Click Logs in the sidebar. Send a message to your agent via Telegram - watch the log entry appear in real time.

Inspect Memory Files

Click Memory to view:

- MEMORY.md - persistent notes your agent writes to itself
- SOUL.md - agent identity and persona
- AGENTS.md - sub-agent definitions

View Plugins and Skills

Click Plugins to see all enabled and disabled plugins. Click Skills to see installed skills and their status.

View Channel Status

Click Channels to see Telegram and WhatsApp connection status.

Step 4 - Restart the Gateway from the Dashboard

Click Gateway → Restart. Wait 5 seconds and refresh the page.

Expected: Dashboard reconnects and shows Gateway: running.

Verification

Check	Expected
http://localhost:18789/?token=YOUR_TOKEN	Dashboard loads in browser
Logs panel	Real-time log entries visible after sending a Telegram message
Channels panel	Telegram shown as active
VPS: openclaw dashboard --no-open	Full URL with token printed

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Fix
Browser shows empty reply	Add ?token=YOUR_TOKEN to the URL
openclaw dashboard opens wrong browser on VPS	Use --no-open and copy the URL manually
VPS tunnel: dashboard not loading	Confirm SSH command is still running in another terminal
Dashboard shows blank page	Hard-refresh the browser (Ctrl+Shift+R)

Symptom	Fix
Token not found	Re-run: <code>docker exec openclaw sh -c 'node -e "const c=require(process.env.HOME+"/.openclaw/openclaw.json"); console.log(c.gateway.auth.token);"'</code>

Reference

- Dashboard: <https://docs.openclaw.ai/dashboard>
- SSH tunneling: <https://support.hostinger.com/en/articles/ssh-tunneling>